

The **Regional Flag of the Hong Kong Special Administrative Region of the People's Republic of China** depicts a white stylised five-petal Hong Kong orchid tree (*Bauhinia × blakeana*) flower in the centre of a [Chinese red](#) field. Its design is enshrined in [Hong Kong Basic Law](#), the territory's constitutional document,^[1] and regulations regarding its use, prohibition of use, [desecration](#), and manufacture are stated in the Regional Flag and Regional Emblem Ordinance.^[2]

The original design of the flag of [Hong Kong](#) was unveiled on 4 April 1990 at the Third Session of the [Seventh National People's Congress](#).^{[3][4]} The current design was approved on 10 August 1996 at the Fourth Plenum of the [Preparatory Committee of the Hong Kong Special Administrative Region](#).^[5] The use of the flag is regulated by laws passed by the 58th executive meeting of the [State Council](#) held in [Beijing](#).^[6] The flag was officially adopted and hoisted on 1 July 1997, during the [handover ceremony](#) marking the [handover](#) from the United Kingdom back to China.^[7]

A variant of the flag known as the [Black Bauhinia](#) has been used by [anti-Chinese](#) government protesters in Hong Kong, particularly during the [2019–2020 Hong Kong protests](#). In contrast of the protests, pro-government supporters often display the [Chinese](#) and Hong Kong flags.^[8]

The [design of the flag](#) comes with cultural, political, and regional meanings. The colour itself is significant; red is a festive colour for the [Chinese people](#), used to convey a sense of celebration and nationalism.^[9] Moreover, the red colour is identical to that used in the [national flag of the People's Republic of China](#),^[10] chosen to signify the link re-established between post-colonial Hong Kong and [mainland China](#). The position of red and white on the flag symbolises the "[one country, two systems](#)" political principle applied to the region. The stylised rendering of the *Bauhinia × blakeana* flower, a flower discovered in Hong Kong, is meant to serve as a harmonising symbol for this dichotomy.^[9] The five stars of the Chinese national flag are replicated on the petals of the flower. The Chinese name of *Bauhinia × blakeana* is most commonly rendered as *yángzǐjīng* (洋紫荆), but is often shortened to *zǐjīng* (紫荆/紫荊) in official uses since *yáng* (洋) means "foreign" in Chinese, notwithstanding that the shortened name refers to another genus, *Cercis*.^[11] A sculpture of the plant has been erected in [Golden Bauhinia Square](#) in Hong Kong.^[12]

The [Hong Kong government](#) has specified sizes, colours, and manufacturing parameters in which the flag is to be made. The ratio of its length to breadth is 3:2. In its centre is a five-petal stylised rendering of a white *Bauhinia × blakeana* flower. If a circle was to circumscribe the flower, it would have a diameter 0.6 times the entire height of the flag. The petals are uniformly spread around the centre point of the flag, radiating outward and turning in a clockwise direction. Each of the flower's petals bears a five-pointed [red star](#) with a red trace, suggestive of a flower [stamen](#). The heading that is used to allow a flag to be slid or raised onto a pole is white.^[10]